INTERPERSONAL EFFECTIVENESS SESSION 11

Mindfulness of Others
Clarifying Priorities
Communicating Limits
Making Requests Using DEAR MAN

Mindfulness of Others

FRIENDSHIPS LAST LONGER WHEN WE ARE MINDFUL.

OBSERVE

- ❑ Pay attention with interest and curiosity to others around you.
- ❑ Stop multitasking; focus on the people you are with.
- ❑ Stay in the present rather than planning what to say next.
- ❑ Let go of a focus on self, and focus on others around you.
- ❑ Be open to new information about others.
- ❑ Notice judgmental thoughts about others, and let them go.
- ❑ Give up clinging to always being right.

DESCRIBE

- ❑ Replace judgmental words with descriptive words.
- ❑ Avoid assuming or interpreting what other people think about you without checking the facts. (Remember, *no one* has ever observed another person's thoughts, motives, intentions, feelings, emotions, desires, or experiences.)
- ❑ Avoid questioning other people's motives (unless you have very good reasons to do so).
- ❑ Give others the benefit of the doubt.

PARTICIPATE

- ❑ Throw yourself into interactions with others.
- ❑ Go with the flow, rather than trying to control the flow.
- ❑ Become one with group activities and conversations.

Goals of Interpersonal Effectiveness

BE SKILLFUL IN GETTING WHAT YOU WANT AND NEED FROM OTHERS

- ❑ Get others to do things you would like them to do.
- ❑ Get others to take your opinions seriously.
- ❑ Say no to unwanted requests effectively.
- ❑ Other: _____

BUILD RELATIONSHIPS AND END DESTRUCTIVE ONES

- ❑ Strengthen current relationships.
  - ❑ Don't let hurts and problems build up.
  - ❑ Use relationship skills to head off problems.
  - ❑ Repair relationships when needed.
  - ❑ Resolve conflicts before they get overwhelming.
- ❑ Find and build new relationships.
- ❑ End hopeless relationships.
- ❑ Other: _____

WALK THE MIDDLE PATH

- ❑ Create and maintain balance in relationships.
- ❑ Balance acceptance and change in relationships.
- ❑ Other: _____

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Factors in the Way of Interpersonal Effectiveness

❑ **YOU DON'T HAVE THE INTERPERSONAL SKILLS YOU NEED**

YOU DON'T KNOW WHAT YOU WANT

- ❑ You have the skills, but can't decide what you really want from the other person.
- ❑ You can't figure out how to balance your needs versus the other person's needs:
  - ❑ Asking for too much versus not asking for anything.
  - ❑ Saying no to everything versus giving in to everything.

YOUR EMOTIONS ARE GETTING IN THE WAY

- ❑ You have the skills, but emotions (anger, pride, contempt, fear, shame, guilt) control what you do.

YOU FORGET YOUR LONG-TERM GOALS FOR SHORT-TERM GOALS

- ❑ You put your immediate urges and wants ahead of your long-term goals. The future vanishes from your mind.

OTHER PEOPLE ARE GETTING IN YOUR WAY

- ❑ You have the skills but other people get in the way.
- ❑ Other people are more powerful than you.
- ❑ Other people may be threatened or may not like you if you get what you want.
- ❑ Other people may not do what you want unless you sacrifice your self-respect, at least a little.

YOUR THOUGHTS AND BELIEFS ARE GETTING IN THE WAY

- ❑ Worries about negative consequences if you ask for what you want or say no to someone's request get in the way of acting effectively.
- ❑ Beliefs that you don't deserve what you want stop you in your tracks.
- ❑ Beliefs that others don't deserve what they want make you ineffective.

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Overview: Obtaining Objectives Skillfully

CLARIFYING PRIORITIES

How important is:

Getting what you want/obtaining your goal?

Keeping the relationship?

Maintaining your self-respect?

OBJECTIVES EFFECTIVENESS: DEAR MAN

Be effective in asserting your rights and wishes.

RELATIONSHIP EFFECTIVENESS: GIVE

Act in such a way that you maintain positive relationships and that others feel good about themselves and about you.

SELF-RESPECT EFFECTIVENESS: FAST

Act in such a way that you keep your self-respect.

FACTORS TO CONSIDER

Decide how firm or intense you want to be in asking for something or saying no.

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Clarifying Goals in Interpersonal Situations

OBJECTIVES EFFECTIVENESS: Getting What You Want from Another Person

- Obtaining your legitimate rights.
- Getting another person to do something you want that person to do.
- Saying no to an unwanted or unreasonable request.
- Resolving an interpersonal conflicts
- Getting your opinion or point of view taken seriously.

Questions

1. *What specific **results or changes** do I want from this interaction?*
2 *What do I have to do to get the results? What will work?*

RELATIONSHIP EFFECTIVENESS: Keeping and Improving the Relationship

- Acting in such a way that the other person keeps liking and respecting you.
- Balancing immediate goals with the good of the long-term relationship.
- Maintaining relationships that matter to you.

Questions

1. *How do I want the **other person to feel about me** after the interaction is over (whether or not I get the results or changes I want)?*
2. *What do I have to do to get (or keep) this relationship?*

SELF-RESPECT EFFECTIVENESS: Keeping or Improving Self-Respect

- Respecting your own values and beliefs.
- Acting in a way that makes you feel moral.
- Acting in a way that makes you feel capable and effective.

Questions

1. *How do I want to **feel about myself** after the interaction is over (whether or not I get the results or changes I want)?*
2. *What do I have to do to feel that way about myself? What will work?*

Guidelines for Objectives Effectiveness: Getting What You Want (DEAR MAN)

A way to remember these skills is to remember the term **DEAR MAN:**

Describe
Express
Assert
Reinforce
(Stay) **M**indful
Appear Confident
Negotiate

Describe

Describe the current SITUATION (if necessary). Stick to the facts.
Tell the person exactly what you are reacting to.

"You told me you would be home by dinner but you didn't get here until 11."

Express

Express your FEELINGS and OPINIONS about the situation.
Don't assume that the other person knows how you feel.

"When you come home so late, I start worrying about you."

Use phrases such as *"I want"* instead of *"You should," "I don't want"* instead of *"You shouldn't."*

Assert

Assert yourself by ASKING for what you want or SAYING NO clearly.
Do not assume that others will figure out what you want.
Remember that others cannot read your mind.

"I would really like it if you would call me when you are going to be late."

Reinforce

Reinforce (reward) the person ahead of time (so to speak)
by explaining positive effects of getting what you want or need.
If necessary, also clarify the negative consequences of not getting
what you want or need.

"I would be so relieved, and a lot easier to live with, if you do that."

Remember also to reward desired behavior after the fact.

(***continued on next page***)

INTERPERSONAL EFFECTIVENESS HANDOUT 5 (p. 2 of 2)

(Stay)

Mindful

Keep your focus ON YOUR GOALS.
Maintain your position. Don't be distracted. Don't get off the topic.

"Broken record": Keep asking, saying no, or expressing your opinion over and over and over. Just keep replaying the same thing again and again.

Ignore attacks: If another person attacks, threatens, or tries to change the subject, ignore the threats, comments, or attempts to divert you.
Do not respond to attacks. Ignore distractions.
Just keep making your point.

"I would still like a call."

Appear

Appear EFFECTIVE and competent.

Use a confident tone and physical manner;
make good eye contact.

No stammering, whispering, staring at the floor, retreating.

No saying, "I'm not sure," etc.

Negotiate

Be willing to GIVE TO GET.
Offer and ask for other solutions to the problem.
Reduce your request.
Say no, but offer to do something else or to solve the problem another way.
Focus on what will work.

"How about if you text me when you think you might be late?"

Turn the tables: Turn the problem over to the other person.
Ask for other solutions.

"What do you think we should do? . . . I can't just stop worrying about you [or I'm not willing to]."

Other ideas: _____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

Identifying Mindfulness of Others

For each A and B pair, check the more effective response.

- ❑ **1a .** Multi-task and expect the other person to understand.
- ❑ **1B.** Give your complete attention to the person you are with.

- ❑ **2a .** Figure that if you already know someone, you don't really have to pay such close attention to them any more.
- ❑ **2B.** Recognize that closeness is built by attending to and learning more and more about people you care about.

- ❑ **3a .** "My feelings are really hurt by what you did, and the thought went through my mind that you hate me. I know that you don't really, but did you feel that way at the time?"
- ❑ **3B.** "I know you hate me. There is no other reason for what you did to me. Don't tell me differently, either."

- ❑ **4a .** In social situations, throw yourself into interactions.
- ❑ **4B.** Stay reserved and watch social interactions so you don't make mistakes.

- ❑ **5a .** Find people with your values.
- ❑ **5B.** Do little immoral things so as not to be a drag on friendships.

- ❑ **6a .** Be open to people's changing their minds about things, as well as their beliefs or feelings.
- ❑ **6B.** Assume that when people change, they are not trustworthy.

- ❑ **7a .** Evaluate other people's behaviors and thoughts, and tell them that they are wrong or that they should be different when you feel sure you are right.
- ❑ **7B.** If you do not approve of or agree with what another person is doing or thinking, try to understand how it would make sense if you knew the causes.

- ❑ **8a .** "You should stop doing that."
- ❑ **8B.** "I wish you would stop doing that."

- ❑ **9a .** "You are lazy and have given up."
- ❑ **9B.** "I worry that you have given up."

- ❑ **10a .** "I don't think that is correct."
- ❑ **10B.** "How could you possibly think that?"

- ❑ **11a .** Stay in control so that relationships turn out the way you want.
- ❑ **11B.** Go with the flow much of the time when in social interactions with groups of friends.

- ❑ **12a .** Hold back in a conversation until you are sure you like the person.
- ❑ **12B.** Throw yourself into a conversation until you are sure you don't like it.

Clarifying Priorities in Interpersonal Situations

Due Date:_____Name:_____Week Starting: _____

Use this sheet to figure out your goals and priorities in any situation that creates a problem for you. Examples include situations where (1) your rights or wishes are not being respected; (2) you want someone to do or change something or give you something; (3) you want or need to say no or resist pressure to do something; (4) you want to get your position or point of view taken seriously; (5) there with another person; or (6) you want to improve your relationship with someone.

Observe and describe in writing as close in time to the situation as possible.

Prompting event for my problem: Who did what to whom? What led up to what?
What is it about this situation that is a problem for me?
Remember to **check the facts!**

My wants and desires in this situation:

Objectives: What **specific results** do I want? What do I want this person to do, stop or accept?

Relationship: How do I want the other person to feel and think about me **because of how I handle the interaction** (whether or not I get what I want from the other person)?

Self-Respect: How do I want to feel or think about myself **because of how I handle the interaction** (whether or not I get what I want from the other person)?

My priorities in this situation: Rate priorities 1 (most important), 2 (second most important), or 3 (least important).

____Objectives ____Relationship ____Self-respect

Imbalances and conflicts in priorities that make it hard to be effective in this situation: